Hence, the general fertility rate of the country during the period is

$$GFR = \frac{111652}{1163040} \times 1000 = 96.00$$

The age specific fertility rate of the country during the same period is calculated for each reproductive age group and the rates are presented in the following table:

Age Group (in years)	*ASFR*
15 – 20	$\frac{20468}{216410} \times 1000 = 94.58$
20 – 25	$\frac{26983}{213610} \times 1000 = 126.32$
25 – 30	$\frac{22522}{202930} \times 1000 = 110.98$
30 – 35	$\frac{17083}{193300} \times 1000 = 88.38$
35 – 40	$\frac{13456}{173920} \times 1000 = 77.37$
40 – 45	$\frac{11140}{162870} \times 1000 = 68.40$

It can be observed, with respect to *ASFR*, that the women population of the country falling in the age group of 20-25 years have given relatively more live births. The women at the age of 40-45 years have reproduced less number of live births.

8.1.6 Measurement of Population Growth

Every human population, normally, may have a change in its size over a period of time. Each change in the population size may be an increase or decrease in magnitude. Sometimes, the population size may remain without any change. Such a population is known as stable population. The tendency to increase in the population size may be called as **population growth**. Every government requires information about the rate of growth of its population.

If many new born babies in a population are female, the corresponding population size may increase. If gender of the infant deaths is female, change in the population size may be downward. Hence, fertility and mortality rates, individually, do not provide knowledge on population growth.

Quantitative ideas about the growth of a population can be obtained from several measurements. Among them,

(i) Crude Rate of Natural Increase, and

(ii) Pearl's Vital Index

may be considered as the basic indicators of population growth. These two measures can be calculated using the following formulae

Crude Rate of Natural Increase = *CBR* – *CDR*

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